Arturo Bertero

Political Sociologist • Computational Social Scientist • Italian

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EDUCATION

2021–2025 **Ph.D. in Political Science**
Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan (NASP), Italy.

Feb.–Mar. 2024 **Virtual Visiting**
Michigan State University, Belief Systems Lab. Supervisor: Mark J. Brandt.

2018–2020 **MA in Political and Public Communication**
University of Turin, Department of Culture, Politics and Society, Italy.

2019–2020 **Erasmus**
University of Stockholm, Department of Sociology, Sweden.

2015–2018 **BA in Social and Political Science**
University of Turin, Department of Culture, Politics and Society, Italy.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025–2027 **Postdoctoral Researcher (*contratto di ricerca*)**
LONELY-EU, Horizon Europe project, University of Milan. WP leader: Cristiano Vezzoni.

2024–2025 **Postdoctoral Researcher**
SUSPECTS: StUdying SuPply, demand, and Endorsement of Conspiracy TheorieS in six European countries. P.I.: Moreno Mancosu.

2022 **Coding Assistant**
Harmonization of the ITANES dataset. Carried out for the SPS Trend group.

2020 **Research Assistant**
Development of a hate speech dictionary for social media analysis. Research carried out by CODER (Center for Public Opinion and Digital Environment Research), with G. Bobba, A. Seddone, M. Mancosu and F. Vegetti.

2020 **Research Assistant**
Preparation of an expert survey on media populism in Europe. With A. Nai (University of Amsterdam), G. Bobba, A. Seddone, M. Mancosu and F. Vegetti (University of Turin).

2019 **Research Assistant**
Monitoring and mapping of Facebook pages spreading fake news and conspiracy theories. University of Turin, project CODER.

2019 **Research Assistant**
Participant in the H2020 project DEMOS, Democratic Efficacy and the Varieties of Populism in Europe.

TEACHING AND SUPERVISION

2026 **Student supervision**
Clara Comte, Université Paris-Saclay.

2026 **Applied Statistics Lab**
MA Allievi, Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin. Course “Applied Statistics”. Software: RStudio.

2025 **Applied Statistics Lab**
MA Allievi, Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin. Course “Applied Statistics”. Software: RStudio.

2024 **Social and Political Attitudes**
Invited lecture for the class “Social and Political Attitudes”, held by Cristiano Vezzoni. MA DAPS&CO, Data Analytics for Politics, Society & Complex Organizations, University of Milan. Lecture: “Political belief systems as networks of attitudes”.

2024 **Applied Statistics Lab**
MA Allievi, Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin. Course “Applied Statistics”, held by D. Auer, A. Szekely and K. Nalewajko. Software: STATA.

2023 **Survey design**
Lecture for Pepe Research on survey design and implementation.

2020–2021 **Political Science 2.0**
University of Turin, course held by Professor G. Bobba. BA in Social Innovation, Communication and New Technologies.

PUBLICATIONS

JOURNAL ARTICLES

2026 **Bertero, A.**, Williams, M., Vegetti, F., Mancosu, M. (2026). Searching for the core of conspiracy belief systems: the relationship between specific beliefs and generic mentality. *European Journal of Social Psychology*, in press.

2026 Mancosu, M., Biancalana, C., Ladini, R., **Bertero, A.** (2026). Populist attitudes, ideology, and climate change beliefs: a comparative analysis of six European countries. *SocietàMutamentoPolitica*, 17(33), 117–130.

2026 **Bertero, A.** (2026). Conspiracy theories are central to the complex system of predictors of Italian vaccine hesitancy. *Italian Political Science*, 20(3), 239–262.

2026 Mancosu, M., Vassallo, S., Pedrazzani, A., Belluati, M., Ventura, S., **Bertero, A.**, Sumbul, U. (2026). SUSPECTS: supply, demand, and communication of conspiracy theories in comparative perspective. *Italian Political Science*, 20(1), 99–112.

2025 **Bertero, A.** (2025). Beyond constraint: tightness and consensus of political belief systems. *Italian Political Science Review / Rivista Italiana di Scienza Politica*, 1–18.

2025 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G. (2025). Consolidation and change: exploring the impact of anger and network dynamics on inequality belief systems. *Network Science*, 13, e9.

2024 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G., Mijs, J. J. B. (2024). Inequality belief systems: what they look like, how to study them, and why they matter. *Social Indicators Research*, 174(2), 445–472.

2023 Franetovic, G., **Bertero, A.** (2023). How do people understand inequality in Chile? A study through attitude network analysis. *AWARI*, 4, 1–21.

2023 **Bertero, A.**, Scaduto, G. (2023). A midsummer night's dream: political communication during the Italian 2022 electoral campaign. *Italian Journal of Electoral Studies*, 86(1), 13–28.

BOOK CHAPTERS

2026 Biancalana, C., Mancosu, M., Ladini, R., **Bertero, A.** (2026). Support for populist parties and climate change attitudes: evidence from six countries in the aftermath of 2024 European elections. In M. Caiani, M. Solinas, H.-J. Trenz (Eds.), *Conspiracism and Political Conflict* (pp. 131–155). Palgrave Studies in European Political Sociology. Palgrave Macmillan, Cham.

2021 **Bertero, A.**, Seddone, A. (2021). Italy: populist in the mirror, (de)politicizing the COVID-19 from government and opposition. In G. Bobba, N. Hubé (Eds.), *Populism and the Politicization of the COVID-19 Crisis in Europe* (pp. 45–58). Palgrave Macmillan.

2021 **Bertero, A.** (2021). The COVID-19 related communication of Italian politicians and its success on Facebook. In *Current Populism in Europe: Gender-Backlash and Counter-strategies* (pp. 79–94). Heinrich Böll Stiftung Prague.

REPORTS AND OTHER OUTPUTS

2026 **Bertero, A.**, Growiec, K., Luhmann, M., Tang, Y., Vezzoni, C. (2026). LONELY-EU WP3_1A: database of loneliness datasets in Europe. *OSF report*.

2022 Vegetti, F., **Bertero, A.**, Bobba, G., Mancosu, M., Seddone, A. (2022). Fuel my fire. *Blue paper, University of Turin*.

2021 Marincea, A., Školkay, A., Baloge, M., **Bertero, A.**, Bobba, G., Hubé, N., Sotiropoulos, D. A. (2021). Populism and social media: a comparative analysis of populists' shared content and networks on Facebook. *DEMOS*.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer American Journal of Political Science; British Journal of Psychology; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; Information, Communication & Society; Italian Political Science; Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: Attitudes and Social Cognition; Political Psychology; Social Indicators Research; Socius.

Web developer EU Loneliness Explorer.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS AND NETWORKS

2023–present **Member**
ECPR standing groups on affective polarization, political sociology, political communication, political methodology, political psychology and political networks.

2022–present **Member**
American Sociological Association.

2022–present **Informal affiliation**
Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin.

2021–present **Member**
SPS Trend Group, University of Milan.

2020–present **Member**
European Consortium for Political Research.

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND RESEARCH GRANTS

2026 **Early Career Development 2026**
University of Milan la Statale. € 3.500.

2025–2026 **Postdoctoral scholarship (*contratto di ricerca*)**
Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan la Statale. LONELY-EU project. P.I.: Cristiano Vezzoni.

2024–2025 **Postdoctoral scholarship**
Department of Culture, Politics and Society, University of Turin. SUSPECTS project. P.I.: Moreno Mancosu.

2021–2024 **Doctoral scholarship**
Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan.

2021 **Award for the best Master thesis of UniTo**
University of Turin.

2021 **Scholarship awarded by Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin**
Research assistant to the project "Media populism, a comparative analysis based on an expert survey".

2021 ***Cultore della materia***
Public Opinion and Political Communication.

2020 **Teaching assistant**
Professor G. Bobba, University of Turin, Department of Culture, Politics and Society.

ACADEMIC SCHOOLS

2025 Behave Summer School on **agent-based modelling** 2025. University of Milan.

2025 Doing **computational social science** with Python and R. University of Milan.

2024 **AI-GENIE**: automatic item development and validation using LLMs. Statistical Horizons, by Hudson Golino.

2023 **Multilevel models** with R. LEMMA, Learning Environment for Multilevel Methodology and Applications, University of Bristol.

2023 **Egocentric network analysis** with R. By Raffaele Vacca.

2023 NASP-CCA Days 2023: frontiers of methods in social and political science. Organized by NASP, hosted by Collegio Carlo Alberto.

2023 **Psychological Networks** Amsterdam Winter School 2023. University of Amsterdam.

2022 NASP-CCA Days 2022: frontiers of methods in social and political science. Organized by NASP, hosted by Collegio Carlo Alberto.

2021 NASP-CCA Days 2021: frontiers of methods in social and political sciences. Organized by NASP, hosted by Collegio Carlo Alberto.

2020 Course in **quantitative text analysis**, held by F. Vegetti. Advanced course of the excellence project CODER (Center for Public Opinion and Digital Environment Research).

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

2026 **Bertero, A.**, Marolla, F., Vezzoni, C. "Disconnected citizens: social isolation, loneliness, and voter turnout in Europe". *LONELY-EU ambassador meeting*.

2026 **Bertero, A.**, Marolla, F., Vezzoni, C. "Disconnected citizens: social isolation, loneliness, and voter turnout in Europe". *LONELY-EU internal seminar*.

2025 **Bertero, A.**, Mancosu, M., Vegetti, F. "Measuring belief in conspiracy theories across borders: a cross-national psychometric approach". *ISPP, Prague*.

2025 Mancosu, M., **Bertero, A.**, Vegetti, F. "Those who know the most are not always the least deceived: on the concept and measurement of conspiracist knowledge". *ComPol, Milan*.

2025 **Bertero, A.** "Beliefs in conspiracy theories, conspiracist mentality, and political ideology: a comparative approach". *Invited presentation, Department of Political Science, Salzburg*.

2024 **Bertero, A.** "Belief systems as networks of attitudes: conceptualization and implications". *INSNA Sunbelt, Edinburgh*.

2024 **Bertero, A.** "Belief systems as networks of attitudes: conceptualization and implications". *Bicocca University, invited by Giulio Costantini*.

2024 **Bertero, A.** "The political belief systems of Italian voters". *Behave Rendez-vous, Milan*.

2023 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G. "Modelling, estimating, simulating: formalizing attitudes towards inequality as a complex network". *EUSN conference, Ljubljana*.

2023 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G. "Overcoming the structuralist/individualist dichotomy: inequality beliefs from a new network and comparative perspective". *ESRA conference, Milan*.

2023 **Bertero, A.** "Conspiracy theories are central to the complex system of predictors of Italian vaccine hesitancy". *CCA Days 2023*.

2023 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G. "Modelling, estimating, simulating: formalizing attitudes towards inequality as a complex network". *CCA Days 2023*.

2023 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G. "Modelling, estimating, simulating: formalizing attitudes towards inequality as a complex network". *ECPR, Toulouse*.

2023 Franetovic, G., **Bertero, A.** "¿Cómo las personas entienden la desigualdad en Chile? Un estudio de actitudes mediante análisis de redes". *CHISOCNET*.

2023 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G. "Modelling, estimating, simulating: formalizing attitudes towards inequality as a complex network". *SISEC conference, Brescia*.

2022 Franetovic, G., **Bertero, A.** "Overcoming the structuralist/individualist dichotomy: inequality beliefs from a new network and comparative perspective". *1st ISSP User Conference on Social Inequality*.

2022 **Bertero, A.**, Franetovic, G., Moroni, M., Saccomanno, P. "Trust in science and risk perception: studying the adoption of anti-contagion behaviors in Italy during the COVID-19 pandemic". *ResPOnsE COVID-19 workshop, Milan*.

2022 **Bertero, A.**, Rosco, J., Saccomanno, P. "Testing the theory of affective intelligence". *ResPOnsE COVID-19 workshop, Milan*.

2021 Vegetti, F., **Bertero, A.**, Bobba, G., Mancosu, M., Seddone, A. "Populist language, issues, and the success of party communication on Facebook". *6th Prague Populism Conference*.

2021 **Bertero, A.**, Bobba, G., Mancosu, M., Nai, A., Seddone, A., Vegetti, F. "Measuring media populism through a comparative expert survey: a first assessment". *ECPR, section S45, Political Communication in Times of Crisis*.

2021 Vegetti, F., Bobba, G., Mancosu, M., Seddone, A., **Bertero, A.** "Così fan tutti? L'incivility nei commenti alle pagine politiche su Facebook". *SISP*.

2020 **Bertero, A.** "The COVID-related communication of populist leaders and its engagement on social media". *DEMOS online workshop, H2020*.

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent).

Software: **RStudio**, **Rmarkdown**, **Python**, **Shiny**, Stata, SPSS Statistics, Excel, Word, GitHub, NVivo, NetLogo, TeXstudio, PowerPoint, Zotero, Overleaf, Pajek.

Research methods

Agent-based modelling, **AI-GENIE (AI for scale validation)**, **egocentric network analysis**, **multilevel modeling**, **psychological networks**, **structural equation modeling**, **survey research**, correlational class analysis, exploratory graph analysis, expert surveys, factor analysis, in-depth interviews, item response theory, latent class analysis, latent profile analysis, quantitative analysis, regression analysis, research design, survey experiments.